

EXERCISE 5 – CREATING MAPS

USE THE FOLLOWING LAYERS FOR THIS EXERCISE:

- Vector layers
 - Polygon layer – **Kelaniya.shp**
 - Point layer – **Points.shp**
- Raster layers **Sentinel2_TrueColor_TIFF.tif**

Prepare Your Map

Using the skills you have picked up already, add in datasets and set up the symbology and labelling for your layers as per the following:

1. Add in the **Sentinel2_TrueColor_TIFF.tif**
2. Add in the layers **Kelaniya.shp** and:
 - Categorize the symbology to colour the polygons in a variety of colours by GND (“GND_N”)
 - Label polygons with “GND_N”, set the opacity to 60% to make it transparent, set the text size to 8
 - under Formatting tab there is a **Wrap on Character** option, this will let you decide how to shorten the labels so they don’t overrun and look messy, we will simply add a space here to make the labels more concise
 - add a buffer around the label and set the opacity to 60%
3. Add **Points.shp** make colours, set both to 50% transparent.
4. Select band combination for tiff file as 3,4 and 7.

Print Composer

1. From the toolbar select New Print Composer 
2. Name your new print layout “Example_Map”
3. Click OK

A new window will open. This is the Print Composer window where we will put all of our map elements together. The main parts of the Print Composer window that we will be using are the:

1. Composer Items Toolbars
2. The Print Canvas, and

3. The Items Window

Before you begin to put anything on the map, the first thing that you need to set is the size of paper the map will be published on. Right click on the Print Canvas and then select Properties.

- In the Items Window click on the Item Properties tab
- Set the paper size to be A4
- Set the orientation to Landscape

Add Map

1. Select Add Map tool  from the toolbar on the left (Click near the top left corner of the page and drag a box to the bottom right to insert the map)
2. We will now look at how the map is positioned. Does it show the area we would like it to? Is there enough space around the map to add a title, legend and scale bar?
 - To adjust the placement of the map on the page and the extent of the map we can use the following map composer tools:

- The select/move item tool  allows you to select and reposition any element on the Print Canvas, for example the box that the map is in or the legend.

- The move item content tool  allows you to reposition the map within its box.

Add Title

All maps should have a title.

1. Select Add Label  from the Composer Items Toolbars: Left click on some of the white space at the top of the page and drag the cursor to create a text box

This will add a small text box to the map (with the word Lorem ipsum inside) that you can now update using the Item Properties dialog in the Items Window.

- Click on the label in the Items Window
- Change the map label to “Kelaniya”
- Click the Font button to open the Font edit window
- Change Font to size 26
- Place Title text at the top and center of the Print Canvas (use the red/blue guide lines to assist)
- Under Items properties – Appearance – Horizontal alignment, check the circle for “Centre”

Add Legend

We will now add a legend to our map. A legend provides valuable information to help people interpret what a map is showing.



1. Select the Add Legend tool from the Composer Items Toolbars
 2. Left click on the Print Canvas to add the legend
- To remove Legend items, select the legend, then go to the Item Properties panel. Under Legend Items, click on an item and press the minus (-) button.
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- Use the Select/move item tool  to position the legend on the right side of the page

Add Scale bar

- Select Add Scale bar tool  from the Composer Items Toolbars
- Left click on the Print Canvas to add the scale bar
 - Set the Units to kilometers
 - Make sure the Label says km (to indicate that the scale is in meters)
 - You can change the Segments to adjust scale bar
 - And you can change the color of the fonts and how the scale bar looks under the Fonts and Colors option

Add Image (Logos, North Arrow)



1. Select the Add Image tool from the Composer Items Toolbars
2. Left click in a white space on the Print Canvas and drag the cursor to create a box

